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Chris AI Studio — Logic systems for AI

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Claude AI Prompting Technique #1: Force Clarifying Questions

Most interactions with AI fail at the input stage due to a lack of precision and detail, but **Claude needs to know what you actually mean** before can give you a sharp answer!

The fastest way to get there is with a **clarifying questions prompt for Claude AI**.

Say you want to validate a business idea: an app that finds small business leads by scraping public data from Google Business reviews and local websites.

The lazy approach with a vague prompt: *“Research and validate the idea of an app that finds local small business leads.”*

Claude will answer, but without knowing your target customer, your business model, or what makes your app different from Apollo or ZoomInfo, the output is a generic market overview, not a real validation.

The genius approach is to add a line at the end of each request: *“Ask me clarifying questions until you're 95% confident you can complete the task successfully.”*

Claude will map out every assumption in your request and surface the gaps before it writes a single word. Real questions it might ask:

- *“Who’s the primary customer: solo founders, agencies, SMBs?”*
- *“What’s your monetization model?”*
- *“What differentiates you from Apollo or ZoomInfo?”*

Answer those, and Claude produces a targeted research report — market size, competitor landscape, business plan — calibrated to *your* idea. Not a template dressed up as advice.

Pro tip: use this technique whenever your brief is still forming. The questions alone will help you think through what you actually need.

Claude AI Tip #2: Use It as Your Sparring Partner

Agreeing with you is the default mode of most AI tools. It's also the least useful one.

Using Claude AI as a sparring partner breaks that pattern and turns every output into a starting point, not a conclusion.

The Blind Spot Challenge prompt serves to correct a mistake most freelancers and solopreneurs make: taking Claude's first answer as the definitive answer. This isn't analysis, it's delegating your thinking.

After Claude delivers its initial output, follow up with this advanced Claude prompt: *"Be my sparring partner. Identify my blind spots, risks, and assumptions."*

This shifts Claude out of "helpful assistant" mode and into critic mode, and it stops flattering your plan and starts pressure-testing it.

For the small business leads app example, Claude might surface:

- Assumption #1: *"Finding the lead is the hard part."* It's not. Any freelancer can Google "dentists in Phoenix." The real bottleneck is the outreach — what to say, how to convert.
- Assumption #2: *"Apollo doesn't cover hyper-local data."* But Apollo has raised hundreds of millions. If local SMB data is valuable, why haven't they already built it?

Those aren't comfortable questions, that's exactly the point.

Pro tip: run the Blind Spot Challenge prompt after every major output Claude generates, as business plans, content strategies, positioning frameworks.

The faster you find the holes, the faster you build something that holds.

👉 [Claude Power User: Hacks & Technical Optimization](#)

Unlock Claude Genius Mode #3: Create Reusable Skills

Every conversation with Claude contains a workflow worth keeping: instead of rebuilding it from scratch each time, you can turn it into a saved plugin.

One of the most underused **advanced Claude prompts features** available right now, has nothing to do with prompting style but **it's about memory**.

Every time you start a new chat with Claude, do you explain your preferences, workflow, and context for each conversation? That's unnecessary friction.

After every productive chat, especially if you've used techniques #1 and #2, send this message: *"Create a reusable skill based on this chat."*

Deep concept h

Claude will package the workflow into one or more skill files. From a business validation session, it might generate:

- "validate business idea" includes the clarifying questions flow, research structure, and output format
- "sparring partner" activates when you type phrases like *"challenge my thinking"* or *"identify my blind spots"*

Save the skills as a plugin with one click in Claude Desktop, they're now stored in your account.

Two ways to trigger them in new chats:

1. Type / (slash) to see your available skills and select one manually
2. Just describe your task naturally: Claude will recognize when to apply them

Example: New idea: *"AI training for companies that want to use Claude Co-Work."* → Activate the "validate business idea" skill and answer the clarifying questions → Then trigger the sparring partner, Claude's first flag: *"Your biggest competitor is Anthropic itself — they give away this education for free. Your edge needs to be the live, applied, hands-on channel."*

That's the kind of output that actually changes your decision.

Pro tip: after every three or four productive chats, review and update your skills, because Claude AI reusable skills compound over time: the more you refine them, the sharper your workflow gets.

👉 [How to Fix Claude Context Window Limits and Build Long-Term Memory](#)

These three techniques — clarifying questions, sparring partner, and Claude reusable skills — work in any order and on any project type.

Use them once to see the difference, use them consistently, and you'll build a workflow most Claude users don't know exists!

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Written by Chris AI Studio

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I'm Chris, from Italy. As a software scientist I create practical AI prompts that help freelancers, solopreneurs and creators save time and work better.

